MODULE 1

Module 1: Barbering Fundamentals

12 techniques · 36 video lessons



THE BARBER ACADEMY

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Next step

> *Module 1 gives you the foundation every other module builds on: your tools, a clean and safe station, how to stand and hold things, and the eight core skills of a working barber.*

What you will learn in this module

- How to choose, identify and organize clippers, guards, scissors, combs, razors and capes.
- How to sanitize tools and set up a station so every client is safe.
- How to stand, hold your arms and move around the chair without tiring or losing control.
- How to use clippers, guards, scissors, combs and a razor with control.
- How to complete a classic haircut twice: once with clippers and once with scissors.
- How to finish the details: the neckline and the eyebrows.

How to study this module

Each of the 12 techniques follows the same layout: a goal, the tools you need, numbered steps, common mistakes, a practice exercise, a safety note and a time estimate. Read the written lesson first, then watch the curated video lessons from experienced barbers for the same technique. Seeing the movement after you have read the steps makes it much easier to notice the details. Then practice right away, while the steps are fresh.

Do not rush. Most beginners try to move fast and end up with uneven lines and tense hands. Slow, relaxed and accurate beats fast and sloppy, and speed arrives on its own with repetition.

Recommended order of practice

1. Lessons 1 and 2 (tools, sanitation and station setup): read these before touching any tool, and repeat the routine every session.
2. Lesson 3 (posture and stance): practice with no tools, in front of a mirror.
3. Lessons 4 and 5 (clipper handling and guards): practice on a mannequin head.
4. Lessons 6 and 7 (scissors and comb): practice the motion in the air, then on a mannequin.
5. Lesson 8 (razor): practice dry strokes on a practice pad or the back of your own hand with the blade guard in place or no blade, until the angle feels natural.
6. Lessons 9 and 10 (classic cuts): put it all together, clipper version first, scissor version second.
7. Lessons 11 and 12 (neckline and eyebrows): finish every practice cut with these details.

> **Practice safely**
>
> Start on a mannequin head. When you move to a real person, work only on a friend or family member who has agreed, tell them what you are doing, and stop immediately if they feel any discomfort. Never practice cutting on anyone without clear permission.

> **Licensing**
>
> In many places, working on paying clients requires a barber or cosmetology license. Check your local licensing requirements. The certificate of completion from this course is not a license.

> **About the video lessons**
>
> This module lists 36 curated public video lessons from experienced barbers, linked from their original channels. They belong to their creators and links can change over time. Every technique also has complete written steps, so you can follow it without the videos.

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1. Tools & materials overview

> *Recognize every basic barbering tool, know what it does, and arrange your kit so you can find each item without looking.*

Estimated practice time: 30 minutes of study and 15 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Clippers with a set of guards
- Trimmer (outliner)
- Shears (cutting scissors)

- Thinning shears
- Cutting comb and tapered barber comb
- Straight razor or shavette with single-use blades
- Neck duster, spray bottle, cape and neck strip
- Disinfectant, clipper oil and a blade brush

Step by step

1. Lay out your tools on a clean towel in the order you will use them.
2. Pick up the clippers and find the blade, the lever that adjusts blade length, the on/off switch and the guard attachment point.
3. Look at the guards and read the number printed on each one; keep them in number order in a tray or case.
4. Hold the trimmer and note its narrow, close-cutting blade, used for outlines and edges rather than full cuts.
5. Open and close the shears slowly and find the still blade, the moving blade, the tang and the finger rest.
6. Compare the cutting comb and the tapered comb: the cutting comb has even teeth for scissor work, the tapered comb narrows from thick to thin for blending.
7. Look at the razor handle and the blade slot, and learn how to load and remove a fresh single-use blade without touching the cutting edge.
8. Fill the spray bottle with clean water and test the mist setting so it dampens the hair evenly without soaking it.
9. Place the cape and neck strip within reach, with the neck duster beside them.
10. Return every tool to the same spot after use so your hands learn the layout.

Common mistakes

- Mixing up guard numbers because they are stored loose.
- Using the trimmer for large areas it was not designed for.
- Storing blades uncovered where they can be dulled or cause injuries.
- Skipping clipper oil, which makes the blades drag and heat up.
- Using household scissors instead of proper shears.

Practice drill

Without cutting anything, name each tool aloud, describe its job, then set up your full kit in order on a towel three times in a row, aiming to do it with your eyes on the mirror, not your hands.

> **Safety note**
>
> Always pick up razors and shears by the handle and keep points and blades aimed away from your body. Store sharp tools closed or covered, out of reach of children.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Learn the names and uses of essential barber tools for perfect haircuts ✂️ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KRssotFiLuI	Bold Words Daily	Names and uses of essential barber tools for haircuts
BEST BARBER KIT FOR BEGINNERS | Starter Tools & Equipment https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SQKBCKa3aJw	SidhuTheBarber	Starter kit and equipment a beginner barber needs
TOP 12 ESSENTIALS FOR NEW BARBERS 💈 START YOUR JOURNEY WITH THESE ITEMS https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N05Bhm5YbgU	HowToFade101	Twelve essential items for new barbers starting out

2. Sanitation & station setup

> *Prepare a clean, safe station and sanitize your tools so every client is protected from infection and skin irritation.*

Estimated practice time: 30 minutes of study and 20 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Hospital-grade or equivalent disinfectant suitable for tools
- Disinfecting wipes or spray
- Clean towels and a fresh cape
- Soap and water or hand sanitizer
- Disposable gloves
- Sharps container for used blades
- Covered trash bin
- Styptic powder or sterile gauze and adhesive bandages

Step by step

1. Wash your hands thoroughly with soap and warm water for at least 20 seconds before starting.
2. Clear the station and wipe the counter and chair arms with disinfectant, following the contact time on the label.
3. Remove visible hair and debris from clippers, trimmers and combs with a brush before disinfecting.
4. Disinfect tools according to the product directions: spray or wipe blades and combs, and let them air dry fully.

5. Place clean tools on a clean towel or in a clean tray, never on a surface that has not been wiped.
6. Put a fresh neck strip and a clean cape on the client, tucking the strip so it sits between the skin and the cape.
7. Open a new single-use razor blade in front of the client and load it only when you are ready to use it.
8. Put on gloves before doing any razor work, working near skin that is broken or irritated, or handling blood.
9. Between clients, discard used neck strips and blades, brush and disinfect tools, sweep the floor and wipe the chair.
10. Finish the day by cleaning and oiling clippers, emptying the bin and washing capes and towels.

Common mistakes

- Disinfecting tools before removing hair and debris.
- Wiping disinfectant off immediately instead of allowing contact time.
- Reusing a razor blade on a second client.
- Letting the cape touch the client's bare neck.
- Forgetting to wash hands between clients.

Practice drill

Run the full setup and cleanup routine on an empty chair as if a client were arriving: wipe, wash, disinfect, lay out the tools, then reverse the process. Time yourself and repeat until it takes under 10 minutes.

> **Safety note**
>
> If a client is accidentally nicked, put on gloves, apply gentle pressure with sterile gauze or a styptic product, cover with a bandage, discard any contaminated items and disinfect before continuing. Follow local health rules for handling blood.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Barbershop Sanitation Essentials | Clean Setup Tips https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=inracyZdKKg	CADMEN BARBER ACADEMY	Barbershop sanitation essentials and a clean station setup
How to Clean Barber Tools | Avoid Spreading Infection and Outbreaks https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uMtNG2v08VA	Barber Style Directory	How to clean barber tools to prevent spreading infection
Barber Tool Sanitation Tips — Disinfectant Spray and Equipment Care (Part 2) #shorts https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PRs96ij9ZKA	CADMEN BARBER ACADEMY	Disinfectant spray and equipment care tips for tools

3. Posture & stance

> *Learn a balanced stance and relaxed arm position so you can work for hours with control and without back, neck or shoulder strain.*

Estimated practice time: 20 minutes of study and 20 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Adjustable barber chair or sturdy stool
- Mirror
- Mannequin head on a stand
- Comfortable, flat, closed-toe shoes

Step by step

1. Stand with your feet about shoulder width apart and your weight evenly spread between both feet.
2. Soften your knees slightly instead of locking them straight.
3. Keep your spine long and your shoulders down and relaxed, not hunched toward your ears.
4. Raise or lower the chair so the area you are cutting sits at about chest height, which lets your elbows stay near your sides.
5. Keep your elbows close to your body and bend your wrists as little as possible, bringing the hand to the work by moving your whole arm.
6. Stand so you can see the area you are cutting in the mirror and with your own eyes, without twisting your neck.
7. Move around the chair by stepping your feet, not by leaning, and keep a small step with the leading foot toward the direction of work.
8. For the back of the head, stand behind the client with the head slightly tilted forward; for the sides, stand at the client's shoulder and face the work.
9. Hold your guiding hand lightly against the head so the client's head position stays steady.
10. Pause every 20 to 30 minutes to drop your shoulders, shake out your hands and stretch your neck and back.

Common mistakes

- Bending the back forward instead of raising the chair.
- Locking the knees, which causes fatigue and wobble.
- Lifting the elbows high, which tires the shoulders and shakes the hand.
- Twisting the neck to see instead of stepping around the chair.
- Gripping tools too tightly.

Practice drill

Without tools, stand at the chair and practice moving around a mannequin head for five minutes, checking your stance in the mirror at the front, side and back positions. Then repeat holding a comb and a clipper (switched off).

> **Safety note**
>
> Poor posture builds up into pain over time, so treat it as a safety issue. If you feel sharp pain, stop and rest rather than pushing through it.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Barber Body Positioning & Posture | Cut Better, Last Longer & Avoid Burnout https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ti3zLmwzZ18	CADMEN BARBER ACADEMY	Body positioning and posture to cut better and avoid fatigue
This barber stance is favorable for good posture and will evenly distribute your weight 💡🔺 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K9mjSajN3u4	Bricassoo_	Balanced barber stance that distributes weight evenly
Barber Posture Tips — Control, Consistency and Longevity Behind the Chair #shorts https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j_MRhBoaECE	CADMEN BARBER ACADEMY	Posture tips for control and consistency behind the chair

4. Clipper handling

> *Hold the clippers correctly and move them in smooth, controlled strokes so the hair cuts evenly without gouges or lines.*

Estimated practice time: 25 minutes of study and 45 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Clippers with a sharp, oiled blade
- Cutting comb
- Mannequin head
- Neck duster
- Clipper oil and blade brush

Step by step

1. Check the blade is clean and oiled, then switch the clippers on and listen for a smooth, steady hum.
2. Hold the clippers like a pencil or in a relaxed palm grip, with your thumb on one side and your fingers on the other, keeping your wrist neutral.
3. Place the flat of the blade against the head with the teeth just touching the hair.

4. Start a stroke at the lower edge of the hairline and move upward in a smooth motion, keeping the blade flat to the head's curve.
5. Rotate the wrist gently to follow the shape of the head, rather than pushing the corner of the blade into the scalp.
6. At the top of each stroke, flick the blade slightly outward so the hair blends instead of leaving a hard line.
7. Overlap each pass by about half the width of the blade so no strips of longer hair remain.
8. Use your free hand to guide the head, stretch skin where needed, and hold the ear forward when working around it.
9. Clean hair out of the blade often with a brush, and re-oil it after every few cuts.
10. Switch the clippers off before setting them down, and never leave them running unattended.

Common mistakes

- Pressing the blade too hard into the scalp.
- Digging in the corners of the blade, which leaves lines.
- Stroking too quickly so the hair is not fully cut.
- Holding the clippers at inconsistent angles.
- Using a dull or hair-clogged blade.

Practice drill

On a mannequin head, practice upward strokes on the lower back section with a medium guard. Repeat until you can make five overlapping passes with no visible lines, then do the sides.

> **Safety note**
>
> Keep the cord out of your walkway and away from water. Never use electric clippers near wet surfaces, and unplug before cleaning the blade deeply.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How To Hold Clippers https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8dIyNmVCTZI	School of Barbering	How to hold clippers correctly
HOW TO USE CLIPPERS| BEGINNER BARBER TIPS | BARBER TOOLS https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wERFdXCRebg	Barber Style Directory	Beginner tips on using clippers for haircuts
BEGINNER BARBER BASICS: HOW TO USE CLIPPERS & TRIMMERS https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rqsbpWfwAFE	Barber Style Directory	Beginner basics of using clippers and trimmers

5. Guards and guard numbers

> *Understand how guard numbers relate to hair length and choose and change guards confidently for any section of a cut.*

Estimated practice time: 20 minutes of study and 30 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Clipper guard set from #0 to #8
- Clippers
- Cutting comb
- Mannequin head
- Ruler or length chart

Step by step

1. Lay out the guards in order from the smallest number to the largest and read each number printed on the side.
2. Learn the rule: each guard number equals the length in eighths of an inch, so a #1 leaves about 1/8 in, a #2 about 1/4 in, a #4 about 1/2 in and a #8 about 1 in.
3. Remember that guard numbers describe the cut length, not the thickness of the guard, so a higher number leaves longer hair.
4. Choose a starting guard for the section: use a larger number than you think you need, since you can always go shorter.
5. Slide the guard onto the blade until it clicks firmly into place and check both sides are seated.
6. Cut a small test patch at the back of the head to confirm the length is what you expect.
7. Work in the direction of the cut, usually bottom to top against the grain, with the guard flat to the head.
8. To blend two lengths, switch to the next number up or down and repeat the same stroke, overlapping the area where they meet.
9. Use the lever on adjustable clippers to fine-tune between guard numbers, and note where the lever sits.
10. Remove the guard after each use, clean out the hair and store it in numerical order.

Common mistakes

- Starting with a guard that is too short and being unable to go back.
- Not seating the guard fully, which causes an uneven cut.
- Forgetting that hair type and growth patterns change how the cut looks.
- Mixing guards between sets that have different sizing.
- Skipping the test patch.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, cut five test patches, one with each of #1, #2, #3, #4 and #6. Measure each with a ruler and compare the result with the chart in your notes.

> **Safety note**
>
> Do not force a guard onto the clippers and replace guards that are cracked or loose, because they can slip and leave a bald patch or scrape the skin.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
(6/9) EXPLAINING THE CLIPPER GUARD SYSTEM : FREE Online Barber School https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ONT5FjXdakM	ThePhoenixBarber	The clipper guard system explained for new barbers
Clipper Numbers Explained | What's the Difference Between #1, #2 & #3? https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xFoVstvIgQE	BarberBar Barbershop	Differences between the #1, #2 and #3 guards
Clipper Guards Explained The Easy Way MUST WATCH!! https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JIff5NJqudA	EZBLADESHAVINGPRODUCTS	Clipper guards explained in simple terms

6. Scissor technique

> *Hold and open and close the shears with a relaxed hand, using the moving blade only so cuts are clean and controlled.*

Estimated practice time: 25 minutes of study and 40 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Sharp barber shears (about 6 to 7 inches)
- Cutting comb
- Spray bottle with water
- Mannequin head
- Cutting cape

Step by step

1. Place the ring finger of your dominant hand in the ring of the still blade and rest the pinky on the finger rest.
2. Put your thumb in the ring of the moving blade, only to the first joint, not all the way through.
3. Rest the pad of your index and middle fingers gently along the shank for stability.
4. Open and close the shears by moving only your thumb, keeping the still blade steady and your wrist relaxed.

5. Practice opening and closing in the air slowly until the motion is smooth and quiet.
6. Dampen the hair evenly with water so it lies straight and cuts predictably.
7. Take a small section of hair with the comb in your other hand, lift it to the length you want, and hold it firmly between your fingers.
8. Cut straight across the section with the shears parallel to your fingers, taking small cuts rather than one large snip.
9. Check the result by combing again and cutting any uneven strands.
10. Carry the shears closed when you move around, and never cut dry, thick sections with a delicate pair.

Common mistakes

- Pushing the thumb all the way through the ring.
- Moving both blades instead of only the thumb blade.
- Using shears that are dull or not suited to hair.
- Cutting too much at once.
- Holding the shears with a tense wrist.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, take 1 inch sections along the top, comb straight up, and trim a quarter inch off each. Aim for a level line. Repeat for 15 minutes.

> **Safety note**
>
> Keep the points of the shears pointed away from the client's scalp and ears, and never cut near the ear without protecting it with your free hand.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Scissor Savvy: The RIGHT Way to Hold Hair Shears (For Beginners & Pros!) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9F5oYraCRvw	TXJ Hairstyling	Right way to hold hair shears for beginners
How To Hold Scissors/Shears & Comb | Barbering Breakdown #2 | Barber Jase https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FB77GtpYWfE	Barber Jase	How to hold shears and comb together
Life Changing Hack To Holding Your Scissors | Barber Tutorials https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kGK7EyeOZCQ	CMCBARBER	Tip for holding scissors comfortably while cutting

7. Comb technique (comb and scissor-over-comb intro)

> *Use the comb as a guide for length, then combine it with the shears in a basic scissor-over-comb motion to blend short sections.*

Estimated practice time: 25 minutes of study and 45 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Cutting comb
- Tapered barber comb
- Shears
- Spray bottle
- Mannequin head

Step by step

1. Hold the comb with your thumb on top and your fingers underneath, with the teeth pointing away from you.
2. Comb the hair in the direction it grows so it lies flat and free of tangles.
3. For scissor-over-comb, slide the comb into the hair with the teeth angled upward and the spine against the scalp.
4. Move the comb slowly upward, lifting the hair so it stands above the comb's teeth.
5. Cut the hair that sticks out above the comb with the shears, using only the moving blade and small snips.
6. Keep the shears parallel to the comb's spine so the cut is even.
7. Move the comb and shears in rhythm, comb up, snip, comb up, snip, without stopping and without lifting the comb off the head.
8. Work from the bottom of the head toward the top, changing the angle of the comb gently to create a gradual taper.
9. Check your result by combing in the opposite direction and looking for steps or lines.
10. Smooth any rough spots by repeating the motion with lighter pressure.

Common mistakes

- Rushing the stroke so the hair is not lifted evenly.
- Lifting the comb away from the scalp too soon, leaving long hairs.
- Holding the shears at an angle that cuts into the comb.
- Working on wet, stuck-together hair.
- Using the spine of the comb inconsistently.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, practice scissor-over-comb on the back section for 15 minutes, starting at the nape and working up, aiming for a smooth gradient from short to longer.

> **Safety note**
>
> Keep your fingers behind the comb at all times and never place a finger in the path of the blade. Work slowly when starting so snips stay controlled.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How to SCISSOR OVER COMB ✂️ | Barbering Breakdown #5 | Barber Jase 🖊️ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nFoEqqLbFLo	Barber Jase	Scissor over comb breakdown for barbers
How To: Scissor Over Comb Technique for Haircutting https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_YTuhDs6Oz0	Free Salon Education	Scissor over comb haircutting technique demonstrated
How To Cut Men's Hair - Scissor Over Comb Barbering Tecnnique https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZYAY3TEUjGI	MastersOfBarbering	Cutting men's hair with scissor over comb

8. Razor technique & safety

> *Use a straight razor or shavette with a fresh blade to create clean edges, with correct angle, skin tension and safety habits.*

Estimated practice time: 30 minutes of study and 60 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Shavette or straight razor with fresh single-use blade
- Disposable gloves
- Shaving cream or gel
- Warm towel
- Clean cloth or gauze
- Styptic powder or sterile gauze
- Sharps container
- Practice pad or mannequin

Step by step

1. Wash your hands, put on gloves and disinfect your station before opening a fresh blade.
2. Load the new blade securely in the handle, touching only the spine, and dispose of it in the sharps container afterward.

3. Hold the razor like a pencil between your thumb and fingers, with the blade at about a 30-degree angle to the skin.
4. Apply a thin layer of shaving cream or gel over the area and soften the skin with a warm towel.
5. With your free hand, stretch the skin gently so it is taut and smooth.
6. Use light, short strokes with the blade moving away from your guiding hand and, for beginners, with the direction of hair growth.
7. Keep the razor moving at a steady pace and never press down or drag the blade sideways.
8. Wipe the blade clean on a cloth or gauze every few strokes.
9. Rinse the area with warm water, pat dry and apply an alcohol-free soothing product if appropriate.
10. Remove the blade with care and drop it into the sharps container, then disinfect your hands and station.

Common mistakes

- Pressing too hard so the blade cuts the skin.
- Using too steep an angle that scrapes instead of glides.
- Reusing a blade on more than one client.
- Not stretching the skin tight.
- Working on irritated or broken skin.

Practice drill

Practice on a practice pad or on a foam board with shaving cream first, using a blade-less or guarded handle, and rehearse the angle and stroke for 15 minutes. Only move to a real person once you feel confident, with permission and with gloves.

> **Safety note**
>
> Use a new blade for every client and discard it in a sharps container. If the skin is nicked, stop, apply pressure with sterile gauze or styptic, cover with a bandage and disinfect. Do not use a razor on skin with rashes, sores or active infection.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
BEGINNER BARBER BASICS: 14 STROKE RAZOR SHAVE STEP BY STEP https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4pXZMtX57D0	Barber Style Directory	Step-by-step straight razor shave strokes for beginners
Comfort and Control During Straight Razor Work | Quick Barber Tutorial https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ozPff4NY0CA	CADMEN BARBER ACADEMY	Comfort and control during straight razor work
How to Use a Razor for a Clean Neck Shave https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tbNStX8nCfo	Clip Master	Using a razor for a clean neck shave

9. Classic cut (clipper)

> *Complete a tidy, even clipper haircut with a short tapered sides and back and a slightly longer top.*

Estimated practice time: 30 minutes of study and 75 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Clippers with guards #1 through #4
- Trimmer
- Cutting comb
- Neck duster
- Cape and neck strip
- Spray bottle
- Mannequin head or a consenting friend

Step by step

1. Sanitize, drape the client with a clean neck strip and cape, and agree on the desired length.
2. Comb the hair to check growth patterns and note any cowlicks or crowns.
3. Start at the nape with a #1 or #2 guard and run it upward against the grain to about the height of the ear, using overlapping strokes.
4. Repeat on the sides, moving from the sideburn to behind the ear, keeping the guard flat against the head.
5. Switch to a #3 guard and blend the line where the shorter length meets the longer length by flicking the clippers out at the top of each stroke.
6. Use a #4 guard to blend up to the parietal ridge, the widest part of the head, using the same upward and out motion.
7. Comb the top hair straight up and trim it to the desired length with the clippers using a longer guard or with shears.
8. Check the sides and back in the mirror, looking for any lines or uneven areas, and repeat blending where needed.
9. Use the trimmer to outline around the ears and the sides of the forehead, following the natural hairline.
10. Brush off hair, remove the cape and give the client a mirror to check the final result.

Common mistakes

- Making the taper line too high or too sharp.
- Forgetting to blend between guards.
- Taking too much off the top in the first pass.

- Leaving uneven lengths at the sideburns.
- Ignoring natural cowlicks.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, complete the full cut in the order above and time it. Take photos of the back and sides and check for lines. Repeat three times, trying to improve blending each time.

> **Safety note**
> Keep the clipper blade flat against the head and use light pressure around the ears, neck and temples where skin is thin. Stop if the client feels pulling or heat.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How To Cut Men's Hair With CLIPPERS | Beginners Guide https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J9cmcNn8BLI	The One Minute Barber	Beginner guide to cutting men's hair with clippers
Basic Mens Haircut | Step by Step Guide https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Fbwd_Pdykk	The One Minute Barber	Basic men's haircut step by step
The simplest men's haircut with clippers https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ki6Ocmnahg0	The One Minute Barber	Simple men's haircut done with clippers

10. Classic cut (scissors)

> *Cut a full haircut with only shears and a comb, producing a clean and even shape with a soft taper.*

Estimated practice time: 30 minutes of study and 90 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Shears
- Cutting comb
- Tapered comb
- Spray bottle
- Clippers or trimmer for the neckline (optional)
- Cape and neck strip
- Mannequin head or a consenting friend

Step by step

1. Sanitize, drape the client and dampen the hair evenly with the spray bottle.
2. Comb the hair in the direction of natural growth and part it into sections: top, sides and back.

3. Start at the nape with a small horizontal section and use the comb and shears to cut the length you want, using the first cut as a guide.
4. Work upward in horizontal rows, bringing each new section down to meet the guide and cutting it to match.
5. Move to the sides, using scissor-over-comb to taper the hair from short at the ear to longer higher up.
6. Cut the top by lifting sections straight up with the comb and trimming the ends to a consistent length.
7. Blend the top into the sides by combing hair down and trimming any steps or lines.
8. Check each section in the mirror, combing hair in different directions to look for uneven spots.
9. Trim around the ears and the neckline with the shears or a trimmer to create a clean outline.
10. Dry the hair, style it as the client prefers and brush off loose hair.

Common mistakes

- Cutting hair that is too wet in some areas and dry in others.
- Taking sections that are too large to control.
- Skipping the guide section.
- Not checking the shape from several angles.
- Cutting the top too short before blending.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, complete the cut using only shears and a comb, working slowly. After finishing, compare the result with your clipper cut and note one thing to improve.

> **Safety note**
>
> Keep your fingers well clear of the blades and hold the ear forward when cutting near it. Use short, controlled snips instead of long ones.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
The Best TUTORIAL Classic Medium Men's Haircut With Scissors | by Farley Santiago https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=h6de0db_6pI	UBarber Academy	Classic medium men's haircut with scissors
How To SCISSOR CUT Men's Hair | Step by Step Tutorial for Beginners https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UkL-JFsY1M0	The One Minute Barber	Scissor cutting men's hair step by step for beginners
How to SCISSOR CUT MENS HAIR | Step by Step Instructions https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ccb9ajR6yk8	The One Minute Barber	Step-by-step instructions for scissor cutting men's hair

11. Neckline technique

> *Create a clean, even neckline in the style the client prefers, whether tapered, squared or rounded.*

Estimated practice time: 20 minutes of study and 40 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Trimmer
- Clippers with zero-gap blade (optional)
- Neck duster
- Cutting comb
- Razor (optional, for advanced finishing)
- Mirror
- Cape and neck strip

Step by step

1. Ask the client to tilt their head slightly forward and relax their shoulders.
2. Comb the hair at the nape downward and check the natural hairline for its shape and any growth patterns.
3. Decide on the style: tapered (fading into the skin), squared (a straight horizontal line with sharp corners), or rounded (a soft curve).
4. For a tapered neckline, hold the trimmer with the blade teeth facing out and work upward from the skin, flicking the trimmer outward to fade the line.
5. For a squared line, draw a straight horizontal line across the nape with the trimmer and then trim the corners to sharp angles.
6. For a rounded line, start at the center of the nape and curve gently up toward each side, keeping both sides symmetrical.
7. Clean up stray hairs below the line with the trimmer, working with short, controlled strokes.
8. Stretch the skin gently with your free hand to avoid nicks on the loose skin of the neck.
9. Brush away hair with the duster and check the symmetry from the back.
10. Adjust any uneven spots, then finish by removing loose hair and giving the client a final check in the mirror.

Common mistakes

- Making the neckline too high, which looks harsh when it grows out.
- Uneven sides or corners.
- Cutting into the natural hairline in a way the client does not want.
- Leaving stray hairs below the line.

- Pressing the trimmer too hard into the skin.

Practice drill

On a mannequin, draw each of the three neckline shapes with a washable marker, then practice tracing them with the trimmer. Do each shape three times.

> **Safety note**
>
> The neck has soft, loose skin and sensitive areas. Keep the trimmer flat, use light pressure and stop right away if the client feels any discomfort.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How to Taper the Neck (step by step guide) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IVzPtZQeD1Q	The Rosh Man	Step-by-step guide to tapering the neck
How to Taper (Fade) Your Neck https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iQJDf52DJcA	The Rosh Man	How to taper the neckline cleanly
HOW TO DO A NECK TAPER 🔥🪒 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8M50ltb08gM	Dreclipperhands	Neck taper demonstration

12. Eyebrow technique

> *Clean and shape the eyebrows by trimming stray hairs and tidying the outline with small, careful strokes.*

Estimated practice time: 20 minutes of study and 30 minutes of practice

Tools you need

- Small eyebrow trimmer or small scissors
- Fine spoolie or brow comb
- Tweezers
- Cotton pads
- Mild antiseptic wipe
- Good lighting
- Gloves

Step by step

1. Wash your hands, put on gloves and clean the tools with an antiseptic wipe.
2. Have the client sit upright in good light and look straight ahead with the eyes relaxed.
3. Brush the brows upward and outward with the spoolie or brow comb to see the natural shape.

4. Trim any hairs that extend past the top edge of the brow by holding the small scissors flat against the comb and cutting only the hairs poking through.
5. Brush the hairs downward and trim any that hang below the lower line.
6. If using a trimmer, set it to the lowest-risk setting and run it lightly across stray hairs between the brows, moving away from the eye.
7. Remove obvious stray hairs between the brows and below the brow line with clean tweezers, pulling in the direction of growth and holding the skin taut.
8. Step back and compare the two brows, checking that the height, length and thickness look balanced.
9. Wipe the area with a clean cotton pad and apply a soothing product if the client has sensitive skin.
10. Discard used cotton pads and disinfect your tools.

Common mistakes

- Removing too much hair and creating a thin brow.
- Cutting hair that is not part of the stray growth.
- Working in poor lighting.
- Failing to compare both brows.
- Pulling hair against the direction of growth, which can cause redness.

Practice drill

Practice on an illustration or on a photo of a face using a pencil to map the brow outline. Then, with permission, practice brushing and trimming on a friend, doing only light cleanup and stopping at any discomfort.

> **Safety note**
>
> Work slowly with sharp points near the eyes, and have the client close their eyes when trimming near the lid. Do not work on irritated skin, and stop if there is any redness, pain or watering.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How To: Line Up Eyebrows Like a Pro | Easy Eyebrow Tutorial by Flexxinruee https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=95ulnsJrKeU	Flexxinruee	Lining up eyebrows with a professional approach
HOW TO DO EYEBROWS WITH PARTS (EASY) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ea7oKQLh29A	Dreclipperhands	Easy eyebrow design using parts
HOW TO ARCH EYEBROWS WITH RAZOR | QUICK TUTORIAL https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGC8LqowEQQ	Sly Huncho	Arching eyebrows with a razor, quick tutorial

Next step

Practice each technique on a mannequin head until you can repeat it with clean results, then move to the next module.